MEXICAN WEDDING COOKIES FROM TARTINE

MAKES	ACTIVE TIME	TOTAL TIME	OVEN
24 small cookies	**20 min**	**about 1 h 30 min**	**325F for 25 min**

INGREDIENTS

150 g	Walnuts
285 g	All-purpose flour
225 g	Unsalted butter, at cool room temperature
40 g	Confectioners' sugar, for the dough
1/2 tsp	Salt
1 tsp	Vanilla extract
1 tsp	Water
quantity not given	Confectioners' sugar, for coating

METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 325F and line a baking sheet with parchment or a nonstick liner.
2. Run the walnuts in a food processor until they are finely ground, about 30 seconds.
3. Sift the flour into a small bowl and set it aside.
4. Fit a stand mixer with the paddle and cream the butter with the confectioners' sugar and the salt, on medium, for a minute.
5. Still on medium, add the vanilla and the water.
6. Scrape the sides and the base of the bowl down with a rubber spatula.
7. Drop to low speed, add the ground walnuts and mix about 30 seconds, then add the sifted flour. Stop the mixer the moment everything is evenly combined.
8. Drop mounds of dough onto the lined sheet with a small cookie scoop, leaving 2.5 cm between them.
9. Bake 25 minutes, to golden brown.
10. Move the cookies to a wire rack and let them cool.
11. Sift confectioners' sugar into a medium bowl and toss the cooled cookies through it until coated.
12. Wait half an hour and toss them a second time for a whiter, cleaner finish.

NOTES

Grind the walnuts to a fine meal rather than a paste. Around 30 seconds in the processor is enough.
The butter goes in at cool room temperature, not fully softened.
Scoop the mounds small. Larger ones are worse.
Leave 2.5 cm between the scooped mounds on the sheet.
The second toss in sugar, after the cookies have sat half an hour, is what produces the clean white coating. No weight is given for this sugar.
Sealed from the air, a week is fine in a cool kitchen and a fortnight chilled.

LEARNINGS

- Make the balls small. That is the one thing to change next time.

DATE ___ / ___ / ___ RATING ___ / 5 OVEN ADJ _____

NOTES _____

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